

Going to school

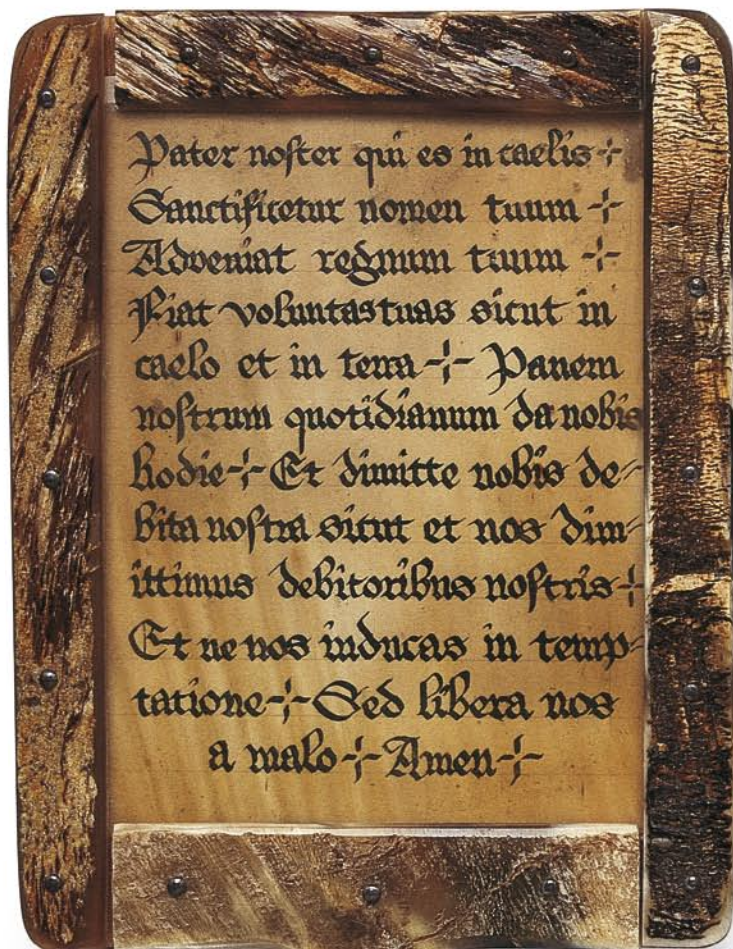


BIRCH BEATING
Schoolmasters always carried a bundle of birch twigs. This was used to beat pupils when they were disobedient or when they made mistakes with their schoolwork.

AT ABOUT THE AGE of four, William Shakespeare would have gone to a "petty school" to learn to read. This was a small private school for boys and girls.

At six, girls left the petty school to be taught at home by their mothers or, if they were rich, by private tutors. At the same age, if their parents could afford not to send them out to work, sons of middle-class men like John Shakespeare were provided with free education at the local grammar school. The

purpose of the school was to teach Latin. At the time, people needed to know Latin if they wanted to go to a university, in order to follow a career in politics, law, medicine, teaching, or the Clergy.



Pater noster qui es in caelis -
Sanctificetur nomen tuum -
Adveniat regnum tuum -
Fiat voluntas tua sicut in
caelo et in terra - Panem
nostrum quotidianum da nobis
hodie - Et dimitte nobis de-
bita nostra sicut et nos dim-
ittimus debitoribus nostris -
Et ne nos inducas in temp-
tatione - Sed libera nos
a malo - Amen -

READING MATTERS
Children learned to read using a "hornbook," a piece of wood covered with printed paper, protected by a sheet of transparent horn. This hornbook is for learning the Lord's Prayer in Latin. Every pupil had to learn this prayer by heart.

RELUCTANT PUPILS

Most boys hated going to school. The hours were long, the lessons were dull, and their behavior was strictly controlled. "When I should have been at school," wrote author Thomas Nashe in 1592, "I was close under a hedge or under a barn playing at Jack-in-the-box."

"Our Father which art in Heaven"
in Latin, from the Lord's Prayer

19th-century painting illustrating
Jaques's speech about a whining
schoolboy in *As You Like It*



With his hornbook and
satchel, the boy described
in *As You Like It* sets off
"unwillingly
to school."